THE CATHOLIC DIOCESE OF TANGA

TANGA CATHOLIC SECONDARY SCHOOLS UNION (TACASSU)

FORM FOUR JOINT PRE-NATIONAL EXAMINATION 1

FOOD AND HUMAN NUTRITION

Time 3:00 HRS **2026**

Instructions

1. This paper consists sections **A, B** and **C**
2. Answer all questions in section A and B and two questions from section C
3. Write your **examination number** on every page of your answer booklets
4. Cellular phones are not allowed in Examination room.

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SECTION A (16 MARKS)

Answer **all** questions in this section

1. For each of the items(i) – (x), choose the correct answer from the given alternatives write letter beside the item number in the answer booklets provided.

(i) A student is preparing vegetables for lunch. She wants to retain as much of the vegetables' nutrients as possible while cooking them. Which practice is most appropriate?

A. Cut the vegetables into very small pieces and boil them in plenty of water.
B. Soak the vegetables in water for a long time before cooking.
C. Cut the vegetables into reasonably large pieces and cook them for a short time using little water.
D. Cook the vegetables for a very long time until they become very soft.
E. Leave the vegetables uncovered in water overnight before cooking.

(ii) A family has a limited food budget but wants to prepare nutritious meals throughout the week. Which practice would best help the family achieve this?

A. Buying expensive foods whenever they are available.
B. Preparing a meal plan and shopping according to the available budget.
C. Buying only one type of food for the whole week.
D. Avoiding locally available foods.
E. Preparing meals without considering the number of family members.

(iii)A student is preparing a meal using a cooking method in which food is cooked by hot vapour produced from boiling water, without being immersed directly in the water. Which method is being used?

A. Steaming
B. Roasting
C. Frying
D. Grilling
E. Baking

(iv) Dairy processing plants in Arusha heat milk to a specific temperature for a short period to kill pathogenic microbes without changing its nutritional value. What is this process called?

A. Sterilization
B. Fermentation
C. Homogenization
D. Pasteurization
E. Condensation

(v) Due to widespread cases of goiter in a certain village, the government mandated the addition of iodine to all commercial table salts. What is this nutritional intervention called?

A. Food supplementation
B. Food enrichment
C. Food fortification
D. Food preservation
E. Food additives

(vi) During food preparation, a student accidentally drops a small amount of oil onto the kitchen floor. Which immediate management practice should be taken to maintain kitchen safety?

A. Cover it with a clean piece of dry cloth
B. Wipe it immediately with hot water and detergent
C. Leave it to dry on its own
D. Spray it with air freshener
E. Sweep it using a plastic broom

(vii) Why should perishable foods be stored in a refrigerator?

A. To increase moisture content
B. To improve flavour only
C. To prevent growth of microorganisms
D. To reduce food weight
E. To change food colour

(viii) Which of the following foods require no or minimal preparation?

A. Reheated foods
B. Packed meal
C. Food additives
D. Convenience foods
E. Parboiled food

(ix) Which stimulants present in coffee and tea can stimulate the central nervous system?

A. Nicotine
B. Papain

C. Caffein
D. Alcohol
E. Tannin

(x) When selecting fresh raw eggs for baking a cake, which physical characteristic of the shell indicates that the egg is of good, fresh quality?
A. Shiny and smooth shell
B. Rough and matte shell
C. Thin and translucent shell
D. Cracked and glossy shell
E. Soft and pliable shell

2. Match each situation in **List A** with the most appropriate cooking method in **List B** by writing the letter of the correct response beside the corresponding item number.

LIST A	LIST B
(i) A cook prepares fish by placing it in an oven with dry heat until it is cooked and browned. (ii) A cook prepares vegetables by placing them above boiling water so that hot vapour cooks them. (iii) A cook prepares potatoes by completely immersing them in boiling water. (iv) A cook prepares meat using a small amount of hot oil in a frying pan. (v) A cook prepares meat by exposing it directly to radiant heat from a grill. (vi) A cook prepares a tough piece of meat slowly in liquid in a covered pan until it becomes tender.	A. Steaming B. Boiling C. Roasting D. Grilling E. Frying F. Stewing G. Baking H. Braising

SECTION B (54 MARKS)

Answer **all** questions in this section

3. A Form Four student has developed symptoms of vitamin A deficiency.
(a) Mention three foods rich in vitamin A that the student should consume regularly.
(b) State two functions of vitamin A in the body.
(c) Identify one deficiency disease or condition caused by lack of vitamin A.

4. A local boarding school wants to update its menu to support adolescent learners during their physical growth spurts. Design a one-day balanced meal plan suitable for an active adolescent. Present your answer using a clear table featuring: Breakfast, Lunch, and Dinner.

5. During a school health talk, students at Seypalm secondary school were told that malnutrition is still common in some parts of Tanzania.
   (a) What is malnutrition?
   (b) Identify two types of malnutrition
   (c) Suggest two ways of preventing malnutrition in the community.
6. Your school's Home Economics department wants to bake buns and mandazi for a parent-teacher association (PTA) event.
   (a) Differentiate between chemical raising agents and biological raising agents as used in flour mixtures.
   (b) State three rules that a baker must follow to ensure successful results when working with yeast mixtures.
   (c) Identify four common faults that can cause a cake to sink in the middle during baking.

7. (a) Explain how poor food handling practices can lead to foodborne diseases and suggest two good practices to prevent them.
   (b) Distinguish between Chemical and Biological food poisoning.
8. A student who participates in high-endurance long-distance running requires a carefully planned diet to optimize athletic performance. Suggest:
   (a) Two carbohydrate-dense foods suitable for glycogen loading before a race.
   (b) Two high-quality protein foods to assist in muscle tissue repair after training.
   (c) One mineral-rich food choice that prevents muscle cramping, explaining its physiological benefit to the athlete.

SECTION C (30 MARKS)

Answer **two** questions from this section

9. Discuss six factors that influence food choices among individuals and families.

10. Explain the causes, symptoms, and prevention of protein-energy malnutrition (PEM) in children (Give four points for each)

11. Proper nutritional management is critical when planning and preparing meals for recovering patients (convalescents) at home or in healthcare facilities. Discuss six dietary guidelines a nutritionist must consider to accelerate the recovery process of a convalescent.